

Mastery English (C2 Proficiency)

A 13-week, 26-class course for adults who already command English and now want mastery: the exact word, the right register, the meaning beneath the words, and prose and speech that move people. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you work on nuance and idiom, irony and imagery, stance and cohesion, rhetoric and style, world Englishes and literature, writing for real readers, diplomacy and mediation between languages, exam technique and public speaking, and you finish by delivering and defending a masterwork. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

LEVEL	DURATION	EACH CLASS	CONTENT
CEFR C2 · Proficiency	13 weeks · 26 classes	90 minutes · 2 × week	8 modules · 24 lessons

CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Every class has **one lesson** from the online course, except the two assessment classes, and every class ends in a demanding **workshop**: close reading, editing, stylistic writing, negotiation, or a talk. Lessons 4.3 and 8.3 are **review projects**: a halfway masterwork, and a final masterwork delivered and defended in discussion. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

WEEK 1

The Exact Word & the Right Room

Module 1: choosing a word on every axis at once, then choosing a whole manner.

C1

1.1

Fine Shades of Meaning — The Mot Juste

denotation vs connotation · *frugal* / *stingy* · semantic prosody (*cause*, *set in*) · force, register, specificity · *bemused* ≠ *amused*

✓ I can choose the exactly right word for connotation, force, and company.

C2

1.2

Register Agility & Tone

field, tenor, mode · one message, five levels · tone as a second dial · the register clang · jargon, slang, archaism

✓ I can re-pitch one message across the formality cline, with no stray clang.

WEEK 2**Ready-Made Phrases & the Unsaid**

Modules 1–2: the prefabricated layer of English, then what speakers mean but never say.

C3

1.3

Fixed Expressions, Binomials & Advanced Collocation

by and large · part and parcel · a foregone conclusion, a moot point · lexical bundles · the garble (for all intents and purposes)

✓ I can use fixed chunks exactly, sparingly, and in the right register.

C4

2.1

Implicature, Inference & Reading Between the Lines

said vs meant · the cooperative maxims · damning with faint praise · presupposition triggers and loaded questions · hinting and understatement

✓ I can decode, and deliver, a message that is never stated.

WEEK 3**Irony & Image**

Module 2: humor, wordplay, and the figures that make the abstract felt.

C5

2.2

Irony, Humor & Wordplay

verbal irony vs sarcasm · understatement and litotes · hyperbole · situational and dramatic irony · puns, malapropisms, spoonerisms

✓ I can hear irony and make a dry joke land, in the right company.

C6

2.3

Figurative Language — Metaphor & Imagery

metaphor, simile, metonymy, synecdoche · ARGUMENT IS WAR · live, dead, and clichéd · the sustained metaphor · mixed metaphors

✓ I can carry an argument in one controlled image, and never mix it.

WEEK 4**Stance & Architecture**

Module 3: the small words that color a text, and the structure that holds a long one together.

C7

3.1

Discourse Markers & Stance

organizing markers by register · *admittedly, arguably, ostensibly, tellingly · so-called, supposedly · mind you, the thing is*

✓ I can signpost a commentary and color it with a precise attitude.

C8

3.2

Cohesion & Coherence Across Long Texts

cohesion vs coherence · theme and rheme, given before new · lexical chains vs elegant variation · signposting · the one-sentence-per-paragraph test

✓ I can re-engineer a disjointed text into one line of thought.

WEEK 5**Other Voices, Then Your Case**

Modules 3–4: handling sources fairly, then building a case that persuades.

- C9 **3.3** **Summarizing, Paraphrasing & Synthesis**
the précis · genuine paraphrase vs patchwriting · reporting verbs and stance · synthesis by idea, not by source
✓ **I can condense and combine sources faithfully, with fair attribution.**
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- C10 **4.1** **Rhetoric & Persuasion — The Art of Argument**
ethos, pathos, logos · tricolon, anaphora, antithesis, chiasmus · claim → warrant → concession → refutation · fallacies
✓ **I can build and deliver a persuasive case, and take a dishonest one apart.**

WEEK 6**Voice & a Halfway Masterwork**

Module 4: style and editing, then the first review project.

- C11 **4.2** **Style, Voice & Creative Command**
rhythm and sentence variety · periodic vs loose sentences · omit needless words · strong verbs · edit in passes; kill your darlings
✓ **I can edit my own prose for economy, rhythm, and voice.**
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- C12 **4.3** **Review Project — Mastery in Action**
orchestration · re-pitching for the room · a 5–6 minute talk and an unscripted discussion · the mastery rubric · Modules 1–4 in action
✓ **I can orchestrate the first-half toolkit in one talk and defend it.**

WEEK 7**Halfway Check & the World's Englishes**

Module 5: a progress check, then English as a family of varieties.

- C13 **TEST** **Progress Test 1 (Modules 1–4) + Catch-Up**
~62-min written check · 9-min pair speaking · catch-up stations
✓ **I know what is already reliable and what to polish next.**
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- C14 **5.1** **Varieties of English — Accents, Dialects & Global Englishes**
rhoticity, the *bath* vowel, t-flapping, the glottal stop · *lift* / *elevator* · *-ise* / *-ize* · Indian, Singaporean, Nigerian English · intelligibility, not imitation
✓ **I can follow, and respect, speakers of many Englishes.**

WEEK 8**Reading Deep, Listening Fast**

Module 5: literature and complex texts, then fast, authentic media.

C15

5.2

Reading Literature & Complex Texts

subject vs theme · narrative voice and the unreliable narrator · parsing periodic sentences · allusion, imagery, symbol, irony

✓ I can close-read a literary text and defend my reading with evidence.

C16

5.3

Decoding Authentic Media — Slang, Cultural Reference & Fast Speech

slang that dates · noticing a reference · elision, linking, *gonna* / *whatcha* · sarcasm in the delivery · riding the gist

✓ I can follow fast, reference-heavy media and cope with what I miss.

WEEK 9**Writing for Readers**

Module 6: short public forms, then the long form.

C17

6.1

Writing for an Audience — Op-eds, Reviews & Articles

earn the next line · hook, line, evidence, landing · description → evaluation → verdict · matching the publication

✓ I can write an op-ed or a review that a real reader chooses to finish.

C18

6.2

The Long Form — Extended & Research Writing

the argued outline · a through-line and informative headings · signposting at every seam · attribution verbs and plagiarism · the abstract

✓ I can plan a long piece and write the abstract that stands for it.

WEEK 10**The Fine Grain & the Unwritten Rules**

Modules 6–7: polish at the level of the comma, then pragmatics across cultures.

C19

6.3

Fine Points of Usage & Punctuation

who / *whom*, *fewer* / *less*, *that* / *which* · dangles and parallelism · the semicolon, colon, and em dash · myths worth retiring

✓ I can proofread to an educated reader's standard, and tell a rule from a myth.

C20

7.1

Cross-Cultural Pragmatics — Politeness, Taboo & Humor

directness vs indirectness · a hedge as a refusal · compliments and silence · sensitive topics handled abstractly · the repair toolkit

✓ I can read and bridge a cross-cultural misunderstanding without blame.

WEEK 11**High Stakes & Between Languages**

Module 7: diplomacy and negotiation, then mediation between languages.

C21

7.2**Diplomacy, Negotiation & High-Stakes Communication**

acknowledge → counter · *If you were able to..., then we could...* · face-saving bridges · the cushioned difficult message · calm under pressure

✓ **I can negotiate firmly and deliver hard news clearly and kindly.**

C22

7.3**Working Between Languages — Translation & Interpreting Awareness**

why word-for-word fails · false friends · untranslatable words, conveyed · translation vs interpreting · signal → image → meaning → feeling

✓ **I can carry a meaning across languages when the word itself won't cross.**

WEEK 12**Exam Technique & the Stage**

Module 8: proficiency-exam strategy, then delivery.

C23

8.1**C2 Proficiency Exam Skills (CPE / IELTS 8+)**

open cloze, word formation, key word transformations · the "true but not there" trap · band descriptors · the collaborative task

✓ **I can show my command under exam conditions, if I choose to sit an exam.**

C24

8.2**Public Speaking & Delivering with Impact**

the open, the spine, the close · pace, pause, and stress · rapport and nerves · rhetoric performed · poised Q&A

✓ **I can deliver a talk in which the delivery carries the meaning.**

WEEK 13**The Masterwork & the Summit**

Module 8: the capstone, the final check, and a celebration.

C25

8.3**Review Project — Your Masterwork & Lifelong Command**

the whole range, integrated · deliver and defend · self-assessment against the C2 standard · habits of lifelong command

✓ **I can deliver and defend a masterwork, and I have a plan for what comes next.**

C26

TEST**Final Test + Celebration**

~62-min written test · ~12-min individual interview · certificates

✓ **I can show what I command in English.**

EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE

0:00	Warmer & review of the last class A speaking task that recycles last class's language
0:10	Input & analysis A text, talk, or model · meaning, form, register & effect
0:30	Focused practice Controlled work on the key choices, checked with a partner
0:50	<i>Break (5 min)</i>
0:55	The workshop task Close reading, editing, stylistic writing, negotiation, or a talk
1:20	Critique & “I can...” Precision, appropriacy, naturalness & effect · peer critique · tick the can-do checklist
1:25	Homework set-up The online lesson with  audio + one workbook page

COURSE DETAILS

■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR C1.** You can place events precisely in time and calibrate certainty, use inversion, clefts, and nominal style, write essays, reports, and professional emails, read arguments critically, follow lectures, and hold your own in a seminar.
- ◆ Finished **Advanced English (C1)**? You're ready. New to our program? Take the shared **placement test** first.
- ◆ Learners whose reading and writing lag behind their speaking are welcome. Every lesson has support options, and the tests have an adapted version.
- ◆ No computer needed in class. A phone or computer helps for homework and for recording yourself, but it isn't required.

■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 24 lessons, written in C2 English (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** with workshop, critique, and discussion norms, and QR codes to the online lessons
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, role-play and negotiation cards, listening scripts, games, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: **Mastery English (C2)**, with  audio
- ◆ A free **learning-tools page** that shows how to translate lessons into any language

■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** an “I can...” checklist and critique of the workshop task, with no grades

- ◆ **Class 13 • Progress Test 1** (Modules 1–4): listening for implicature and attitude, word choice and collocation, register rewrites, stance, a close reading of a column, the opening of a persuasive talk, and a 9-minute pair speaking task

- ◆ **Class 26 • Final Test** (all 8 modules): listening, a literary close reading, original proficiency-style Use of English, an op-ed, review, or synthesis (about 300 words), and a 12-minute individual interview with a long turn, an abstract discussion under push-back, and a negotiation or diplomatic task

- ◆ Rubrics follow the CEFR C2 descriptors. Results point to the **next step**, never to who gets to celebrate

- ◆ Tasks about your life can always use a real, general, or imagined example, and in debates you may argue an **assigned side** instead of your own view

■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **45–60 minutes**, with  Listen buttons for model sentences and dialogues

- ◆ Plus one **workbook page**, and serious reading in English every day

- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same ground, so you can catch up

- ◆ After the course: C2 is the top of the CEFR ladder. A proficiency exam is an option if you need the credential; IELTS Academic Preparation and Business English are free specialist tracks

What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners work at **CEFR C2**: they understand virtually everything they hear or read and express themselves spontaneously, very fluently, and precisely, differentiating finer shades of meaning even in complex situations:

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|--|---|
| ✓ Choose the exactly right word for connotation, force, register, and company | ✓ Shift a message across the whole register cline, and control tone independently |
| ✓ Use idiom, binomials, and restricted collocation exactly and sparingly | ✓ Decode and deliver implicature, irony, understatement, and figurative meaning |
| ✓ Signal stance precisely and build long texts that cohere | ✓ Summarize, paraphrase, and synthesize sources faithfully and fairly |
| ✓ Persuade with the classical appeals and figures, and detect manipulation | ✓ Follow world Englishes, literature, and fast authentic media with ease |
| ✓ Write op-eds, reviews, and long-form pieces to an educated reader's standard | ✓ Negotiate, mediate between languages, and deliver a talk with impact |

Companion course, free online: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2 · Free translation & learning tools: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html